【英语一】 2018 阅读 Text4

基础大纲词　精读补充词　核心重难词
常考大纲短语　核心精读短语　考点长难句

P1 ① **The U.S. Postal Service** (USPS) continues to **bleed red ink**. ② It reported a **net loss** of $5.6 billion for fiscal 2016, the 10th straight year its expenses have exceeded revenue. ③ Meanwhile, it has **more than** $120 billion in **unfunded liabilities**, mostly for employee health and retirement costs. ④ There are many reasons this formerly stable **federal institution** finds itself **on the verge of** bankruptcy. ⑤ Fundamentally, the USPS is in a historic squeeze between technological change that has permanently decreased demand for its bread-and-butter product, **first-class mail**, and a regulatory structure that denies management the flexibility to adjust its operations to the new reality.

①美国邮政（USPS）持续处于严重赤字状态。②它公布的数据显示，2016财年的净亏损额高达56亿美元，连续第10年支出超过了收入。③同时，USPS还背负着1200多亿美元的无资金准备债务，其中主要是员工医疗和退休金。④这个联邦机构昔日稳固，如今却处于破产的边缘，其原因很多。⑤根本原因在于，USPS正深陷“历史性挤压”：技术变革导致其赖以为生的产品（普通邮件）需求永久性降低；而监管体系使得管理层无法灵活调整业务适应新现实。

P2 ① And **interest groups ranging from** postal unions **to** greeting-card makers **exert** self-interested **pressure on** the USPS's ultimate overseer — Congress — insisting that whatever else happens to **the Postal Service**, aspects of the **status quo** they **depend on** get protected. ② **This is why** repeated attempts at reform legislation have failed **in recent years**, leaving **the Postal Service** unable to pay its bills except by deferring vital modernization.

①而且，众多利益集团——从邮政工会到贺卡制造商——都在为一己之利，对USPS的最高监管者国会施加压力，坚称无论邮政其他方面发生什么变化，他们所倚赖的现状都要得到保护。②这就是为什么，近年来屡次改革立法的尝试都以失败告终，致使邮政无法支付各种账单，只能推迟至关重要的现代化改造。

P3 ① **Now comes word that** everyone involved — Democrats, Republicans, **the Postal Service**, the unions and the system's heaviest users — has finally **agreed on** a plan to fix the system. ② Legislation is **moving through** the House that would save USPS an estimated $28.6 billion over five years, which could help pay for new vehicles, among other survival measures. ③ Most of the money would **come from** a penny-per-letter permanent rate increase and from **shifting** postal retirees **into** Medicare. ④ The latter step would largely offset the **financial burden** of annually pre-funding **retiree health care**, thus addressing a long-standing complaint by the USPS and its unions.

①如今有消息称，涉及的各方——民主党、共和党、邮政、各工会以及邮政系统的极重度用户——终于就一项修复邮政系统的提案达成一致。②该提案正在经过众议院审议，它将会在五年时间内，为USPS节省约286亿美元，可以帮助它购买新运输工具，以及实施其他生存措施。③这笔钱的大部分将来自于永久性的邮资费率上调（每封信1美分），以及将邮政退休人员转入“联邦医保计划”。④后一举措将大幅抵消每年预付退休人员医保造成的财政负担，并以此化解USPS和工会长久以来的抱怨。

P4 ① If it clears the House, this measure would still have to **get through** the Senate — where someone **is bound to point out** that it **amounts to** the bare, bare minimum necessary to keep **the Postal Service** afloat, not comprehensive reform. ② There's no change to **collective bargaining** at the USPS, a major omission **considering that** personnel **accounts for** 80 percent of the agency's costs. ③ Also missing is any discussion of eliminating Saturday letter delivery. ④ That common-sense change enjoys wide **public support** and would save the USPS $2 billion per year. ⑤ But postal special-interest groups **seem to have** killed it, **at least** in the

①如果众议院批准了该提案，它还需参议院通过——参议院一定会有人指出，该法案仅仅是维持邮政所需的最低最低要求，而非彻底的改革。②USPS内的集体谈判丝毫未变，鉴于员工成本占机构总开支的80%，这是一个巨大的疏漏。③此外，提案丝毫未讨论是否取消周六信件投递服务。④这一常识性的变化受到公众广泛支持，且每年会为USPS节省20亿美元。⑤但是，邮政的特殊利益集团似乎已经将这一想法扼杀，至少在众议院是这样。⑥围绕该提案逐渐形成的共识表明，立法者对USPS短期内崩溃所带来的政治难堪感到害怕。⑦然而，这并非表明他们开始认真改革邮政系统，让其面向21世纪。

House. ⑥ The emerging consensus around the bill is a sign that legislators are getting frightened about a politically embarrassing short-term collapse at the USPS. ⑦ It is not, however, a sign that they're getting **serious about** transforming the postal system for **the 21st century**.

Q1. The financial problem with the USPS is caused partly by____. 细节题

[A] its unbalanced budget

[B] its rigid management

[C] the cost for technical upgrading

[D] the withdrawal of bank support

USPS的财政问题部分缘于____。

A.其不平衡的预算

B.其僵化的管理

C.技术升级的成本

D.银行援助的终止

Q2. **According to** Paragraph 2, the USPS **fails to** modernize itself **due to**____. 细节题

[A] the interference from interest groups

[B] the inadequate funding from Congress

[C] the shrinking demand for postal service

[D] the incompetence of postal unions

根据第二段，USPS未能实现现代化是由于____。

A.利益集团的干涉

B.国会提供的资金不足

C.邮政服务需求萎缩

D.邮政工会的无能

Q3. The long-standing complaint by the USPS and its unions can be addressed by____. 细节题

[A] removing its burden of retiree **health care**

[B] making more investment in new vehicles

[C] adopting a new rate-increase mechanism

[D] attracting more **first-class mail** users

USPS及其工会长期以来的不满可以通过____得到解决。

A.不再负担其退休人员医保

B.增加新运输工具的资金投入

C.采用新的邮资费率增长机制

D.吸引更多普通邮件用户

Q4. In the last paragraph, the author seems to view legislators with____. 态度题

[A] respect

[B] tolerance

[C] discontent

[D] gratitude

最后一段中，作者是以____态度看待立法者。

A.尊重

B.容忍

C.不满

D.感激

Q5. Which of the following would be the best title for the text? 主旨题

[A] The USPS Starts to Miss Its **Good Old Days**

[B] **The Postal Service**: **Keep Away from** My Cheese

[C] The USPS: Chronic Illness Requires a Quick Cure

[D] **The Postal Service** Needs More Than a Band-Aid

以下哪项是本文的最佳标题？

A.USPS开始怀恋其美好的往昔

B.邮政服务：别动我的奶酪

C.USPS：慢性病需要速效疗法

D.邮政服务需要的不只是权宜之计